

HOW TO MAKE A JUNGLE IN A BOTTLE

Your little jungle needs a healthy plant potted in clean soil and a 1½–2 quart (1.5–2 liter) bottle, which you pack with some small stones, pistachio shells, and charcoal. Try to find “activated charcoal,” which is extra absorbent. If you can’t, just crush up the ordinary kind. Charcoal soaks up chemicals produced by any dead plants and will stop your jungle from getting smelly!



Time
20 minutes



Difficulty
Medium

WHAT YOU NEED



Masking tape



Pistachio shells



Small stones



Plastic bottle



Water in a spray bottle



Scissors



Crushed charcoal



Potted plant



1 Cut the bottle in two, so that the base is about 4in (10cm) high. Keep the top part for later. Then put a layer of the small stones into the bottom, and charcoal on top.



2 Pour in the pistachio shells on top of the charcoal. These shells act as a barrier to stop the soil that goes in next from falling into the charcoal and the stones below.

3 Gently take the plant out of its pot and place it on top of the pistachio shells. Try not to shake up the layers when you pick up the bottle.

